

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

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WORKING WITH MACROS IN MS WORD



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To use all the macros that follow, you'll need to know where to type in the code. Here is the general procedure in Word 2002 (Word XP).

Go to **Tools > Macro > Macros**.

Under "Macro Name", type in the name of the macro, and click Create. The VBA editor will open up, with the name of the macro and the "End Sub" text filled in. You'll need to type the macro in between these two.

To assign a keyboard shortcut to a macro, go to **Tools > Customize**. In the Commands tab, choose Macros, then choose your macro from the list on the right. Press "Keyboard". Now under "Categories", choose Macros, and choose

your macro from the list on the right. Place the cursor in "Press new shortcut key", and do just that—press the shortcut key you want to use, for example, [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [5]. Finally, click Assign, and OK your way out.

Assigning a toolbar button to your macro is a little harder. Go to **Tools > Customize**, and click the Toolbars tab. Click New and then type in your Toolbar name. Click OK. You should see a new menu listed and checked. The checkbox indicates that this menu is in use. You can also see that on your document, there is a floating toolbar. Now click the Commands tab. Click Macros in the Categories list. You will see your macro listed in the commands list as Normal.NewMacros.MacroName.

Drag this macro from the Commands list to your new toolbar. The toolbar will change its appearance. Drag the item to where you'd like it on the Standard Toolbar.

To customise the appearance of your button, on the Tools menu, click Customize. With the Customize dialog box open, do the following: click the Normal.NewMacros.MacroName button on the toolbar. Then in the Customize dialog box, click Modify Selection, click Name on the shortcut menu, and then type over the current name with a new name. Click the Normal.NewMacros.MacroName button on the toolbar. And in the Customize dialog box, click Modify Selection, point to Change Button Image on the shortcut menu, and then click an image.



Bold Italics

Aren't so many words and phrases bold *and* italicised? The two often go together. To bold-italicise something requires two actions, whether on keyboard or by mouse. Wouldn't it be nice to have a toolbar button called "BI" that does it, or a single keystroke? Here's a macro for just that.

Sub BI1()

```
Selection.Font.Bold = True
Selection.Font.Italic = True
End Sub
```

The macro above turns on bold and italics, but it can't do any toggling—meaning you can't turn off bold italics using the same macro. So here's a longer macro that toggles our bold-italics procedure.

Sub BI2()

```
Dim B1Status As Integer
B1Status = 0
If Selection.Font.Bold Then B1Status = B1Status + 1
If Selection.Font.Italic Then B1Status = B1Status + 1
If B1Status = 0 Then
    Selection.Font.Bold = True
    Selection.Font.Italic = True
End If
If B1Status = 1 Then
    Selection.Font.Bold = True
    Selection.Font.Italic = True
End If
If B1Status = 2 Then
    Selection.Font.Bold = False
    Selection.Font.Italic = False
End If
End Sub
```

The way we've written this macro, it will convert text to bold + italics in two cases: if neither bold nor italics is on, or if either of them is on. If both are on, it removes both the bold and the italics. Inspect the code a little and you'll get the hang of what's going on, and then you can change the macro to what you want.



Remove Hard Returns

Most ASCII files—such as those you might download off the Net, and then need to put in Word in a presentable format—have a hard return, the equivalent of an actual [Enter] keypress, at the end of every line of the file. They also have two hard returns at the end of every paragraph, so you can't just globally replace hard returns with an empty value. The macro that follows formats a file so there are only hard returns at the end of paragraphs:

```
Sub RemoveHardReturns()
    Remove1 "^p^p", "{ |}"
    Remove1 "^p", "{ @}"
End Sub
```